Baskets and trays in cane, bamboo and coir

Baskets, trays, plates and containers, made from cane, bamboo, coir, palm and palmyra leaves, in different shapes and sizes from many centres in India are tastefully displayed at the Lalit Kala Gallery, Greams Road. They give us a cross section of the rich variety of baskets, (with a regional flavour) incidentally, *revealing craftsmanship of excellence, beauty* and utility. Covering wide regions in the North and the South, these articles have been gathered under one roof, for the first time in this city. West Bengal, Uttar Pradesh, Assam, Bihar, Arunachal Pradesh, Nagaland, Karnataka, Kerala, Tamil Nadu and the far off Andamans, find ample representation here in the shape of many attractive articles.

A striking exhibit is the "khore", a shopping basket made by Angalmi tribesmen from Nagaland, carried by women for shopping. Woven like a "V" shaped bowl, it is made of cane over a bamboo scaffolding to give it shape and strength. Decorative mats, baskets and cane modas from West Bengal, flower and fruit baskets from Uttar Pradesh, fish baskets, table mats, rice ladels and coir split cane baskets from Kerala, square trays (from bamboo shavings) from Warangal, "solagus" and "kottakulam seerpetti" from Chettinad and "moram" from Andamans, constitute colourful cargo.

A special workshop highlighting the processes and skill employed by trained craftsmen in the weaving of baskets from palmyra leaf, was conducted by the Crafts Council from Feb. 2 to 8.

The Exhibition jointly organised by the Crafts Council of India and the Development Commissioner (Handicrafts) Government of India will be on view till Feb. 12, daily from 10 a.m. to 1 p.m. and 3 p.m. to 7 p.m.

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